[METRIC]
A-A-2859A
March 22, 1994
SUPERSEDING
A-A-2859
December 29, 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TAPE, POSTAGE METER

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description, for all federal agencies.

1. Scope. This Commercial Item Description covers gummed and pressure sensitive postage meter tape.

2. Classification. Tapes shall be furnished in the following types:
   Type I - Tape, Gummed
   Class 1 - 81 m (265 ft) length, gummed side out
   Class 2 - 20 m (65 ft) length, gummed side in
   Type II - Tape, Pressure Sensitive

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza New York, N.Y. 10278.

FSC 7530

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3. Requirements.

3.1 General. Paper stock shall be white or very light pastel color. The paper must be suitable for coating on one side with adhesive that will not migrate through to the printing surface and be capable of absorbing meter ink on the printing side with a minimum of smearing.

3.1.2 Warning signal. Both roll edges shall show a red signal stripe of approximately 91 cm (3 feet), starting within 91 cm (3 feet) of the end of the tape and extending to the core. The warning signal shall be a continuous or broken red stripe of such width as to provide at least 2.54 cm (1 inch) clear tape, so that the meter stamp impression will be clear and legible.

3.1.3 Type I

3.1.3.1 Adhesive. Adhesive shall not absorb moisture from an atmosphere of 75% relative humidity sufficient for it to stick in the tape track of the machine or block in the roll.

3.1.3.2 Edges. Edges shall be either straight or serrated.

3.1.4 Type II.

3.1.4.1 Construction. Tape shall be of 2-ply paper construction. The printing paper shall have one surface capable of being printed on with postage meter ink and the other side coated with a pressure sensitive adhesive. The release liner shall be designed to carry and protect the printing paper while being fed through a postage meter and to separate the upper ply.

3.1.4.2 Release liner. The release liner shall be a silicone coated paper.

3.1.4.2.1 Dimensions. The release liner, with width of 3.33 cm, +0, -0.39mm (1 5/16" +0,-1/64) shall be made in accordance with Figure 1. The 2.78cm (1 3/32") wide printing paper shall be mounted with a 0.79 mm (1/32") clearance on one side and 4.76 mm (3/16") on the other. On the 4.76 mm (3/16") side, there are feed holes of size 4.76 mm (3/16") in length with a 1.19 mm (3/64") radius spaced 5.7 cm (2 1/4") center to center at the perforations.

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3.1.4.3 Adhesive. Adhesive shall be applied to the 2.78 cm (1 3/32") printing paper strip so that two 4.76 mm (3/16") strips or voids free of adhesive are located 3.1 mm +/- 0.39 mm (1/8" +/- 1/64") from each edge of the strip. The adhesive shall resist penetration of postage meter ink, which may bleed through the printing paper strip. The adhesive shall not flow or bleed under conditions of storage or usage to a degree that would cause either blocking of rolls, separation of the paper layers, or adhesive pick-up by the postage meter feeding mechanism.

3.1.4.4 Printing paper.

3.1.4.4.1 Perforations. The strip shall be perforated at intervals of 5.7 cm (2 1/4") such that the individual, perforated pieces of tape between perforations have a minimum tensile strength of 1.2 kg/15mm. width +/- 0.8 kg/15 mm. width. The area that is unperforated at manufacture and torn after printing shall not have fibers trailing from the edges greater than 0.79 mm (1/32").

3.1.4.4.2 Release liner adhesion. The silicone treated liner shall be such that the printing paper is easily peelable from the release liner. It shall adhere to the release liner without separation while being fed through the postage meter.

3.1.4.5 Tape. Tape shall be constructed in accordance with Figure 1.

3.2 Physical Requirements.

3.2.1 Physical properties. The paper stock and release liner shall conform to the requirements of Table I.

TABLE I

Paper stock	Basis Weight Requirement	Tensile Requirement
Type I	83 g/m2 (56#,25x38-500) +/- 5% (4)	8.0 kg/15mm min.(5)
Type II	74 g/m2 (50#,25x38-500) +/- 5% (1)	4 kg/15mm min.(3)
Release liner for Type II	65 g/m2 (44#,25x38-500) +/- 5% (2)	4.3 kg/15mm min.
Test Method	T 410	T 404

(1) without adhesive
(2) without silicone coating
(3) unperforated printing tape
(4) ungummed paper
(5) with adhesive

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3.2.2 Ink penetration. Ink penetration of the side without adhesive shall be 50 seconds maximum, when tested as follows. A medium heavy meter imprint is made on the sample tape, using fluorescent postage meter ink, and a stop watch is started. The sample tape is immediately placed on a flat surface and covered with 75 g/m2 (20#, 17x22-500) bond paper. A 56 gm (2 oz) weight with a 2.54cm x2.54 cm (1x1") contact area is placed on top of this. No smudging of the print is permissible after 50 seconds, when the bond paper and weight are pulled over the print.

3.2.3 Environmental conditions.
3.2.3.1 Shelf life. Tape rolls shall have a minimum shelf life of 12 months from the date of pack and shall pass any examination or test specified herein provided that they are packaged and stored as specified herein.

3.2.3.2 Storage. Tape rolls shall be capable of being stored continuously at temperatures from -18 deg. C (0 deg. F) to 38 deg. C (100 deg. F) with relative humidities from 25% to 75%.

3.2.3.3 Usage. Tape shall be capable of being used at the same temperatures and humidities at which it is stored.

3.2.4 Blocking.
3.2.4.1 Type I. There shall be no blocking of tape when tested as follows. Rolls of tape shall be conditioned in 75% +/- 2% relative humidity at 49 deg. C (120 deg. F) for 24 hours. Then the rolls are conditioned in accordance with Tappi T-402 for a minimum of 4 hours. The rolls of tape shall be installed in a postage meter indicated in Table III and the entire length run through the meter. Blocking of the tape to itself sufficient to remove fibers or material from the backing of the adjacent strip or delamination of the tape or sticking of the tape to the tape track of the machine shall constitute failure.

3.2.4.2 Type II. The release liner shall prevent blocking when subjected to temperatures from -29 deg. C (-20 deg. F) to 59 deg. C (140 deg. F) at 10% to 90% relative humidity, when tested as follows. Rolls of tape shall be conditioned in 75% +/- 2% relative humidity at 59 deg. C (140 deg. F) for 24 hours. Immediately after removal from the test atmosphere the rolls of tape shall be installed in a Pitney-Bowes, Model 5850 postage meter, or equivalent, and the entire length run through the meter. Blocking of the tape to the release liner sufficient to remove fibers or material from the liner or delamination of the tape by sticking of the tape to the tape track of the machine shall constitute failure.

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3.2.5 Tape Adhesion. When the adhesive is properly moistened with water, the gummed tape must readily and firmly adhere to the types of surfaces commonly used as mailing containers. Pressure sensitive adhesive shall require no heat, moisture, or other preparation prior to application. The tape shall adhere and not strip from the test surfaces without fiber separation, when tested as follows:

Test strips of tape shall be applied at temperatures of 4 deg. +/- 1 deg.C (40 +/- 2 deg. F) and 38 +/- 1 deg. C (100 +/- 2 deg. F) to the following materials. Both the tape and material shall be conditioned for 24 hours in relative humidities of 10% and 90% at temperatures of 4 deg. C (40 deg. F) and 38 deg. C (100 deg. F), respectively. Materials designated under f, g and h apply only to Type II tapes, whereas a, b, c, d and e apply to both Types I and II. Materials a, b, c, d and e shall be commercially available grades.

a. Bond paper
b. Kraft paper
c. Tape
d. Fiberboard
e. Index cards
f. Plastic material which shall include polyethylene and molded polystryene commonly used as mailing containers (Note: Pressure-sensitive adhesive on polyethylene only functions in the range of 25% to 90% RH at 12 deg. C to 32 deg. C (55 deg. F to 90 deg. F) respectively.)
g. Bare metal surfaces which shall include steel, aluminum, and copper. These surfaces shall be wiped free of all solvents, oils, and foreign material.
h. Paint surfaces, which shall include enamel, acrylic and epoxy paint.

Immediately after application to the materials listed above, the initial adhesion of the tape shall be sufficient to prevent curling of the edges of the tape. One hour after application of the Type I tape and 24 hours after application of the Type II tape, the tape strips shall be impossible to detach without removing the surface of the material or without delaminating the strip. After the tape is applied, the material shall be returned to the test chamber for the period of the test.

3.3 Rolls.

3.3.1 Type I.

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3.3.1.1 Dimensions. The length, width and diameter of rolls of tape shall be as specified in Table II.

TABLE II

Type	Min.Length	Outside Max. Diameter	Width
Type I			
Class 1	81 m (265')	12.7 cm (5")	3.33 cm +/- 0.79mm (1 5/16" +/- 1/32")
Class 2	20 m (65')	6.3 cm (2 1/2")	3.33 cm +/- 0.79 mm (1 5/16" +/- 1/32")
Type II	see 3.3.2.1	15.5 cm (6 3/32")	3.33 cm +0, - 0.39 mm (1 5/16" +0,- 1/64")

3.3.1.2 Roll construction. Tape shall not be fastened to the core and shall be of one continuous piece with no splices or patches. However, Type I, Class 1 tape may be fastened to the core with double-back tape. All rolls shall be free from paper dust and lint and shall be wound with the gummed side out, except that Class 2 shall be wound with the gummed side in. The core shall be held firmly in place in the roll. The tape shall be processed through gum breakers to cause the paper to lie flat.

3.3.2 Type II.

3.3.2.1 Dimensions. The outside diameter and width of the rolls shall be in accordance with Table II. The roll shall contain not less than 1,500 individual 5.7 cm (2 1/4") lengths of tape. The tape roll leader shall be a minimum length of 80.0 cm (31 1/2").

3.3.2.2 Roll construction. The adhesive coated printing paper and release liner comprising the tape shall be wound on a core to form the tape roll. Edges of the tape roll shall be straight. Tape shall be wound on the core in one continuous piece with no splices or patches with uniform tension and with the printing surface of the printing paper inside on the roll. The perforations shall neither separate nor buckle when wound on the core. The force necessary to separate the tapes from the core shall not exceed 0.2 kg. The core shall be held firmly in place in the roll.

3.4 Cores. Cores shall be of a uniform finish and may be embossed on the side with the postage meter identification number.

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3.4.1 Type I. Cores shall conform to the dimensions specified in Table III.

TABLE III.

Type	Width	Outside Diameter	Hole Diameter
Type I			
Class 1	3.33 cm +0,-0.79 mm (1 5/16" +0, -1/32")	5.1 cm (2")	1.5 cm +/- 0.39 mm (19/32" +/- 1/64")
Class 2	3.33 cm +0, -0.79 mm (1 5/16" +0,-1/32")	2.5 cm (1")	Cardboard core:1.3cm, +0.79mm,-0mm (1/2" +1/32",-0") Plastic core:1.3 cm, +0.39 mm, -0mm (1/2" +1/64",-0")
Type II	3.33 cm +0, -0.39 mm (1 5/16" +0, -1/64")	4.4 cm (1 3/4")	1.7 cm (0.690") with 8 splines

3.4.2 Type II. Cores shall conform to Figure 2, and dimensions as specified in Table II.

3.5 Workmanship. Tapes shall be clean and free from folds, sharp creases, tears, cuts, holes or any other defects which may affect appearance or servicability. The adhesive coating shall cover the entire specified area of the side to which it is applied. The tape shall be cleanly cut without nicks or ragged edges.

4. Quality Assurance Provisions.

4.1 Inspection.

4.1.1 Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

4.1.2 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all the inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the contractor may utilize

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his own facilities or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this Commercial Item Description, where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Sampling for examination and tests shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, using the plans specified in Table IV, unless otherwise stated. For the purposes of sampling, a lot shall consist of all rolls of paper tape of one size and type offered for delivery at one time. A unit of production shall be one roll, unless otherwise specified. The sample unit shall be one roll of tape, unless otherwise specified.

TABLE IV

Examine	Inspection Level	AQL (%defect)/ acceptance
Workmanship/general	S-3	4.0
Dimensions/Type	S-4	2.5
Physical Requirements	S-2 (1)	2.5 (1)

(1) Tappi tests shall be in accordance with Tappi T400 for the applicable Tappi test methods.

5. Certification. The contractor shall certify that the minimum content standard of the paper tape offered shall be no less than 50% recovered materials including 20% postconsumer materials in accordance with Executive Order 12873, section 504 (b), dated Oct. 20, 1993 (see definition of postconsumer materials and recovered materials in sections 203 and 205). As an alternative to meeting the standards of section 504 (b) for all printing and writing papers, the minimum content standard shall be no less than 50% recovered materials that are a waste material byproduct of a finished product other than a paper or textile product which would otherwise be disposed of in a landfill, as determined by the State in which the facility is located, in accordance with Executive Order 12873, section 504 (c), dated October 20, 1993. The plastic core shall contain reclaimed material to the maximum extent possible. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

5.1 Labeling. The minimum percentages of recovered materials and postconsumer materials cited as requirements in this paragraph

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shall be marked in a suitable manner, such as stamping, printing, or applied with a pressure sensitive label, on the intermediate pack containing the rolls of tape.

6. Applicable Documents and Document Sources. The following documents form a part of this Commercial Item Description to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

6.1 Tappi Standards.

Copies of Tappi Standards are available from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, PO Box 105113, Atlanta, Ga. 30348.

6.2 Federal Standards.

Single copies of Commercial Item Descriptions, federal standards or specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston; New York; Philadelphia; Washington, D. C.; Atlanta; Chicago; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth; Houston; Denver; Los Angeles; San Francisco; and Auburn, WA.

6.3 Military Standards.

MIL-STD-105, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

Copies of Military Specifications and Standards are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Bldg. 4D, 700 Robbins Ave., Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

6.4 Executive Order 12873.

Copies of the Executive Order 12873, dated October 20, 1993 may be obtained free of charge from:
The White House Publications Office,New Executive Office Building, White House, Att: Publications, Washington, DC, 20500. Telephone number (202) 395-7332.

7. Bleaching. To obtain an acceptable brightness, or color, in accordance with this document, a chemical bleaching process may be used. When specified in the ordering data, the bleaching process shall not include the use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, hypochlorite, or other chlorine containing compound. Certification

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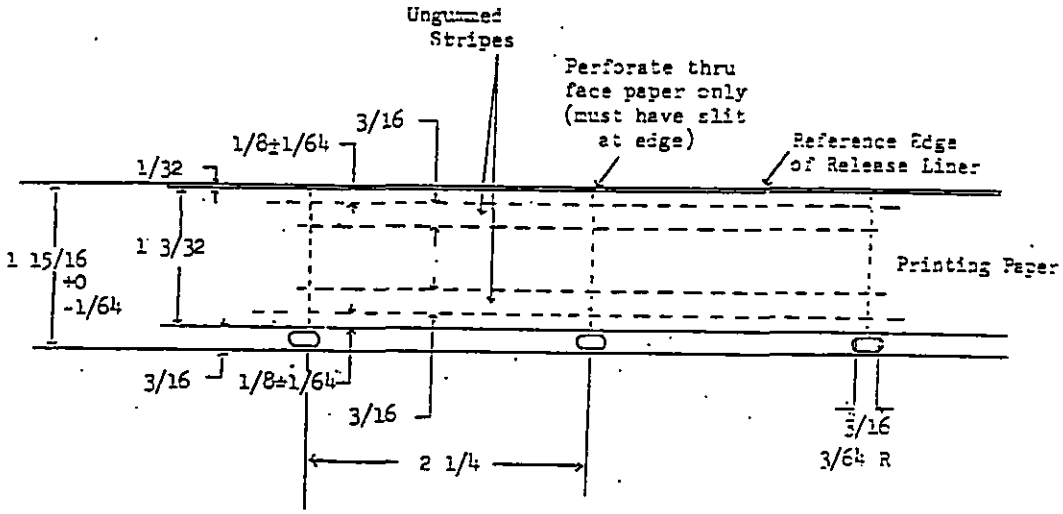
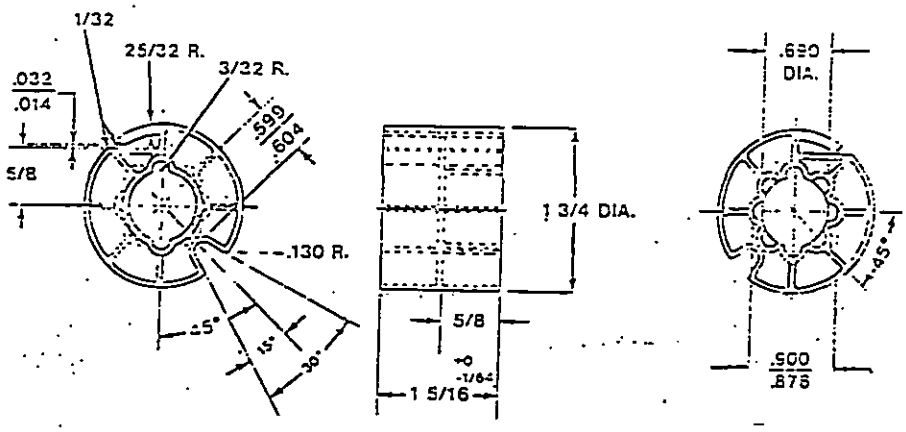


FIGURE 1



NOTES:
1. All walls 3/64 unless otherwise noted.
2. All fillets & radii .010/.020 unless otherwise noted.

FIGURE 2

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of compliance shall be made available upon request by the Government.

8. Packaging, Packing, and Marking. Packaging, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

9. Notes.

A. Ordering Data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(1) Title, number, and date of this Commercial Item Description
(2) Type of roll
(3) If non-chlorine bleaching is desired (see Paragraph 7)
(4) Labeling of recycled content (see par. 5.1)
(5) Packaging, packing, and marking

B. Item Identifiers/Reference Part Number System (For Cataloging Use Only).

The following part identification numbering procedure is for government purposes and does not constitute a requirement for the contractor.

AA2859-3 : This example describes a pressure sensitive postage
: meter paper tape

1- Type I, Class 1 - Tape, Gummed, 81 m (265 ft) min.length, gummed side out
2- Type I, Class 2 - Tape, Gummed, 20m (65 ft) min.length, gummed side in
3- Type II - Tape, Pressure Sensitive

MILITARY INTEREST:

NONE: DoD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA-FSS

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